

SOMETHING LESS THAN THE WHOLE

01 x 04 - "The Door"

Written by

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New York City. It's gloomy. The sky is clouded. Light does not want to come through.

We hear the noises. We see the fumes. We feel the uncharted energy. It's the footstep, the trains, the hotdog stands. It's a lot of people, it's a lot of people. We get none of them. That's not why we are here.

MARK (V.O.)

There's a door. You can't see it,
but it's there. It's right there.

We stroll down upper manhattan, into the morning, past the people walking to the subway, heading to work.

We reach an apartment complex. A man bumps into us, as we look up at the windows. We turn to to him, he looks at us. Can he really see us?

We fly up to a window on the third floor and enter the apartment. We enter from the bedroom. The bed is there, but there's nothing else.

We continue to the next room, it's the only other room and it's empty, but for a mirror.

We close on the mirror and there we seem him. MARK. The water flushes, he comes out of the bathroom and heads in front of the mirror.

He is younger than what we've seen. He is in jeans and a leather jacket. He comes to stand right next to us. He fixes his jacket and leaves the apartment.

EXT. STREET - DAY

Mark comes out of the building. He takes a cigarette and lits it as he heads for the subway.

INT. SUBWAY PLATFORM - DAY

People wait for the subway. The train arrives. People get out and, as people jump back on, we see Mark is one of them.

EXT. STREET - DAY

Mark flows out the subway among the see of people. The hoard goes right and he goes left.

There's a diner right there, he heads in.

After he's gone in, A MAN IN A FEDORA HAT WALKS BY.

INT. DINER - CONTINUOUS

At a table, alone, in front of a cup of coffee, it's ROSENTHAL. She's looking out the window, mindlessly, when Mark sits right in front of her.

ROSENTHAL
You are late.

MARK
I know.

ROSENTHAL
Why are you late?

MARK
Does it matter?

ROSENTHAL
It does.

MARK
I couldn't sleep right.

ROSENTHAL
You never sleep.

MARK
It's been worse.

ROSENTHAL
I know.

MARK
Why am I here?

ROSENTHAL
I am leaving.

MARK
The city?

Rosenthal takes a picture out of her purse, slides it to Mark across the table.

ROSENTHAL
What do you think?

MARK
I don't think.

ROSENTHAL
I'll see you, Mark.

Rosenthal stands up, takes the picture with her.

Mark stops her as she leaves, grabbing her by the arm .

MARK
You won't comeback, will you?

ROSENTHAL
I don't think so.

MARK
Do they want me?

ROSENTHAL
You are already there.

Rosenthal leaves.

Mark rips the picture in two, then leaves as well.

As Mark exits, CAMERA stays at the table, catches the remains of the picture.

CAMERA ZOOMS IN on one halve: it's a door, surrounded by nothing.

CAMERA zooms in so much it gets SUCKED in front of it.

The door CRICKS. The handle SHAKES.

VOICE
(whispered)
Come in.

The handle creaks some more, as if someone were trying to get in, or out.

The door opens. MARK in a grey suit steps out of it, towards CAMERA.

As his foot exits the door, hardwood appears under it.

MARK fully enters, to the void being replaced by...

INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY

Mark is now standing in front of a peach colored wall. The door is gone. He looks ahead, ABOVE THE CAMERA, puzzled.

MARK
What do you think Cheryl? A bit much?

Camera SWINGS left to find Cheryl, composedly observing what Mark was looking at.

She is still in her robe, holding the saucer under a steaming cup of coffee.

She pulls the cup to her lips and takes a small sip.

She reposition the cup on the saucer and tilts her head a little.

CHERYL
(as she moves the cup
handle to be parallel to
her body)
It is a bit much.

Camera turns to find a painting nailed to the wall next to the kitchen counter on the open kitchen.

It's a painting of a young man. Terror in his eyes. Hands of smoke grabbing him from every side. An opaque, void black his only background.

From this perspective we see the spotless kitchen and the pristine apparel of the house. The painting looks even darker, like that's the place where all light goes to die.

CAMERA PUSHES IN on the painting.

MARK
He just looks so scared.

CAMERA KEEPS PUSHING.

CHERYL
Why is he so scared.

CAMERA ZEROES IN on the kid's face.

Then...

Silence. Void. The kid's lips quiver.

KID
Why?

A GUN SHOT.

CAMERS TURNS TO MARK. In the void. Holding a smoking gun.

Mark drops the gun.

We follows the gun falling, in SLOW MOTION.

VOICE

It's a soundless rhythm.

A MUFFLED BEAT grows louder and louder as the gun spins downwards in the void.

VOICE (CONT'D)

Can you hear it?

The gun turns into a wine glass. Hardwood appears under it. Table legs behind it.

The glass hits the floor, breaking into a million pieces.

CHERYL

JESUS CHRIST MARK!

INT. DINING ROOM - DAY

We are back in the peach-walled house.

Cheryl sits across from Mark, still in her robe.

Sunset beams filter through the curtain behind her, a full glass of red wine sits in front of her.

Mark stares at the broken glass.

MARK

I'm sorry, honey.

Cheryl looks at him in disbelief. Picks up her glass and heads for the front door.

She struggles a bit trying to open it.

She finally gets it right. Turns to Mark.

CHERYL

(slurring a bit)

You have a problem, you know?

She swings the door open and exits, slamming the door behind her.

Mark stands up and heads for the kitchen.

We watch him from the dining room as he opens a counter under the sink to pick up a dustpan and brush.

He goes back to the dining room but we STAY on the kitchen.

We hear the sound of glass being brushed on the dustpan.

Light dims. Then dims some more. The sound of glass stops.
Mark sighs, loudly.

CHERYL (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Mark?

Lights go out.

Darkness.

CHERYL (CONT'D)
(louder)
Mark?

A beat.

A deep breath.

A light breeze.

FLASH: a rocky beach at sunset.

A woman's laughter. It's contagious.

EXT. ROCKY BEACH - SUNSET

Feels like a dream.

Camera BLINKS.

A BLONDE WOMAN, in a white dress, appears walking barefoot
on the rocky beach.

We are far away.

She turns to us.

She appears to be smiling tenderly.

We get closer. We float to her. The closer we get to, the
less she seems to be smiling.

She seems mad, actually.

She is furious. Her whole body is tense.

We slow down, but we can't stop.

We reach her. She stares us down in anguish.

WOMAN
(in Cheryl's voice)
MARK!

INT. BEDROOM - DAY

Mark eyes pop open. Alarm going off. Loud. Cheryl standing on his side, she is fully dressed, ready to go.

CHERYL

It's been going for hours! Get up
Jesus Christ! We are going to be so
fucking late.

Mark turns to the alarm clock. 5.07.

INT. CAR - DAY

Rain pours on the windshield, it's loud. You can barely see ahead.

Mark drives slowly, Cheryl sits next to him, nervously and annoyedly bouncing her eyes between Mark and the little clock on the dashboard.

CHERYL

I told you we going to be late.

MARK

You can swim there if you want.

CHERYL

It's not even raining that much.

MARK

Are you kidding me now, Cheryl?

Cheryl frowns, confused. The thunderous rain pour turns into a light ticking.

Cheryl points to the sky ahead.

CHERYL

The sun is even coming out.

Mark leans forward, seeing slivers of sun drilling through the grey clouds.

CHERYL (CONT'D)

MARK!

HE SLAMS THE BREAKS and instinctively extends his arm over Cheryl's chest.

They both look up.

EXT. STREET - SAME TIME

We are behind A MAN IN A FEDORA HAT silhouetted right between Cheryl and Mark.

They are staring up at him, the terror in their eyes tangible.

The Man in The Fedora tips his hat, then proceeds to cross the door.

INT. CAR - CONTINUOUS

Mark and Cheryl lock eyes.

CHERYL
We are definitely late.

MARK
Yes we are.

Mark hits the gas.

The car darts away, as it does, the corner's of Cheryl's smile can't help it but rise.

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